Matt Burke

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mattdburke.github.io

Current Academic Positions

Lecturer in Finance, September 2024 - Present
Sheffield University Management School, University of Sheffield

Green & Sustainable Finance Lead, May 2024 - Present
climaTRACES Lab, University of Cambridge

Advisor to Earth Capital Nexus, March 2026 - Present
Grantham Research Institute, London School of Economics and Political Science

Education

PhD, Finance
University of East Anglia, 2017 - 2021
Thesis title: The [læŋgwɪdʒ] of Finance
Supervisors: Raphael Markellos and Apostolos Kourtis

PG Cert, Learning and Teaching in Higher Education
Sheffield Hallam University, 2014 - 2015

MRes, Social Sciences
Sheffield Hallam University, 2012 - 2014

BA, Economics
Sheffield Hallam University, 2008 - 2012

Previous Academic Positions and Affiliations

Visiting Researcher, November 2024 - December 2025
Environmental Change Institute, University of Oxford

Research Fellow, Jun 2023 - August 2024
Smith School of Enterprise and the Environment, University of Oxford

Fellow, Nov 2023 - August 2024
UK Centre for Greening Finance and Investment (CGFI)

Consultant, Nov 2022 - Nov 2023
Inter-American Development Bank

Lecturer in Finance, Sept 2021 - May 2023
Sheffield Business School, Sheffield Hallam University

Research Associate in Green Finance, Sept 2020 - Sept 2021
Bennett Institute for Public Policy, University of Cambridge

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Oct 2017 – Sept 2020
Norwich Business School, University of East Anglia

Lecturer in Finance, Aug 2014 – Sept 2017
Sheffield Business School, Sheffield Hallam University

Publications

Burke, M., Agarwala, M., Klusak, P. and Mohaddes, K. (2026). Climate Policy and Sovereign Debt: The Impact of Transition Scenarios on Sovereign Creditworthiness. Accepted (in-press) in Environmental & Resource Economics.

Bernhofen, M., **Burke, M.**, Puranasamriddhi, A., Kerkhofs, R., Ranger, N. and Shrimali, G. (2026). Modelling the impact of physical climate risk and adaptation on sovereign credit ratings. Oxford Review of Economic Policy. 42 (2), 475-501.

Agarwala, M., **Burke, M.**, Klusak, P., Kraemer, M., Volz, U. and Sovacool, B. (2026) Biodiversity loss will decrease the future creditworthiness of nations. Nature Ecology & Evolution. 10, 1511–1520.

Klusak, P., Agarwala, M., **Burke, M.**, Kraemer, M., and Mohaddes, K. (2023). Rising temperatures, falling ratings: The effect of climate change on sovereign creditworthiness. Management Science. 69 (12), 7151-7882.

Burke, M., Fry, J., Kemp, S. and Woodhouse, D. (2022). Attention to authority: The behavioural finance of Covid-19. Finance Research Letters. 49 (103081).

Agarwala, M., **Burke, M.**, Klusak, P., Mohaddes, K., Volz, U., and Zenghelis, D. (2021). Climate change and fiscal sustainability: Risks and opportunities. National Institute Economic Review, 258, 28-46.

Fry, J., and **Burke, M.** (2020). An options-pricing approach to election prediction. Quantitative Finance, 20 (10), 1583-1589.

Burke, M., and Fry, J. (2019). How easy is it to understand consumer finance? Economics Letters, 177, 1-4.

Working Papers

Burke, M., Kourtis, A., Loughran, T. and Markellos, R. (2026). Market Reactions to Complex Language in Corporate News.

Burke, M., Mohaddes, K. and Raissi, M (2026). The Adaptation Imperative: Climate Change and Sovereign Credit Risk.

Agarwala, M., **Burke, M.**, Groom, B. and Klusak, P (2026). False Promises & Genuine Opportunities in Biodiversity Finance.

Reports & Policy Briefs

Ramirez V., Surminski S., Bernhofen M., Tan T., Delaney P., **Burke, M.**, Cristancho C., Gopinathan C., Stewart H., Chataigne A., Kennedy A., Ranger N., Martín R. (2026). Chapter 5. Getting practical #2: integrating adaptation into sovereign credit assessments. Climate Financial Risk Forum: From Risk to Resilience: Integrating Adaptation into Finance.

Ranger N., Weidinger M., Bernhofen M., **Burke, M.**, Lambin R., Puranasamriddhi A., Sabuco J., Spacey Martín, R. (2025). Enabling Adaptation: Sustainable Fiscal Policies for Climate Resilient Development and Infrastructure. Environmental Change Institute, University of Oxford and Green Fiscal Policy Network.

Agarwala, M., **Burke, M.**, Doherty-Bigara, J., Klusak, P. and Mohaddes, K. (2024). Climate Change and Sovereign Risk: A Regional Analysis for the Caribbean. *Inter-American Development Bank Working Paper No. IDP-WP-01574*

Books

Fry, J. and **Burke, M.** (2022). Quantitative Methods in Finance Using R. McGraw-Hill Education (UK).

Research Funding and Consultancy

- Natural capital, flood risk and economic resilience - *Sheffield Policy Campus Fellowship* - £15,000 (PI)
- Climate-adjusted credit ratings for sovereigns - *Standard Chartered* - £10,000 (Co-I)
- Inclusive wealth adjusted productivity - *PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC)/Strategy&* - £40,000 (Co-I)
- Climate Change and Sovereign Risk: A Regional Analysis for the Caribbean - *Inter-American Development Bank* - £10,000 (Co-I)
- Biodiversity-adjusted sovereign credit ratings - *Nature Finance (formerly Finance for Biodiversity)* - £100,000 (Co-I)

Media

Research featured in *'Study warns biodiversity loss could trigger wave of debt crises'*
- Reuters, June 2026

Research featured in *'Biodiversity decline threatens sovereign credit ratings, study says'*
- Bloomberg, June 2026

Authored *'Most investors aren't paying attention to climate risks – the financial system needs to change'*
- The Conversation, December 2023

Co-authored *'Climate change is making debt more expensive – new study'*
- The Conversation, August 2023

Research featured in *'Lex in depth: how investors are underpricing climate risks'*
- Financial Times, August 2023

Research featured in *'Climate change puts sovereigns at downgrade risk, study finds'*
- Reuters, August 2023

Research featured in *'Ratings Firms Struggle With Climate Risk In $133 Trillion Market'*
- Bloomberg, August 2023

Research featured in *'Biodiversity Loss May Push Developing World Closer to Default'*
- Bloomberg, June 2022

Co-authored *'Climate finance: it'll be cheaper in the long run if poorer countries receive it as a matter of urgency'*
- The Conversation, November 2021

Research featured in *'A Climate Reckoning Is Coming for the World's Government Debt'*
- Bloomberg, September 2021

'Rising Temperatures, Melting Ratings'
- VoxEU Column, March 2021

Talks and Conferences

- European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE). Norwegian School of Economics. 2025
- Net zero, nature and supply chain vulnerabilities: macrofinancial and environmental implications. LSE. 2024
- Eighth Conference on Econometric Models of Climate Change (EMCC VIII). King's College, University of Cambridge. 2024.
- Latvijas Banka. Invited talk. 2024.
- Frontiers of climate and nature in macroeconomics and finance. Banque de France. 2022.
- The Vienna Institute for International Economic Studies. Invited talk. 2022.
- Banco De España. Invited talk. 2022

Academic Awards

- Winner of the 2025 Financial Times 'Academic Research with Impact' award

Scholarly Activity

- Co-organised the *AI in Finance and Accounting: Opportunities, Challenges, and Societal Implications.* workshop, hosted at the Sheffield University Management School.
- Member of the Royal Economic Society, 2025 - 2026
- DPhil Transfer of Status committee member. Viola Tang. University of Oxford. 2025.
- Designed and delivered the *Climate Finance* course hosted by *apolitical.* 2024.
- Member of the secretariat and internal review for the inaugural Insight Investment/University of Oxford Green Finance Prize, 2023.
- Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (FHEA), 2015.

Reviewer Activity

UKRI - Economic and Social Research Council, The European Journal of Finance, Keynes Fund (University of Cambridge), PLOS One, Emerging Markets Review, World Development, Journal of Business Ethics, International Review of Financial Analysis, International Review of Economics and Finance, Finance Research Letters, Ecological Economics, Network Science, Journal of Accounting Literature, Banco De España Working Paper Series

Programming Skills

Python, R, LaTeX, Stata, Linux

Teaching Activity

University of Sheffield, 2024-Present - Sustainable Finance (PG, (Module Leader)).

University of Oxford, 2023-2025 - Sustainable Finance (PG, Module Leader), Sustainable Finance (Executive education, Director), Climate-related Financial Risk (Executive education).

Sheffield Hallam University, 2014-2017, 2021-2022 - Financial Risk Management (PG), International Derivatives and Risk (Module Leader), Business Economics, Econometrics (Module Leader and Development)

Last updated: November 3, 2026